

2 Kings 4:8-37

The Shunammite woman PERCEIVED the move of GOD and made PREPARATION to RECEIVE and MAINTAIN it.

1. A ROOM - A PLACE for GOD. LORDSHIP...AUTHORITY

A lot of people ask Jesus to forgiveness of sins...but NEVER make Him LORD....

LORD means OWNER!

The KJV says "she made a little chamber
Notice where she built the Chamber...

Put it upon the wall - this demonstrates the preeminence of God in
her life - not hidden away but in full view of all who may pass by.

Again there are people who want God to move in their life but they want it hidden from view.

God's MOVE is OPEN not SECRET.

Have you prepared a chamber for the move of God? Where is it? Is it hidden away or do you make Him the most important part of your life?

4Abide in Me, and I in you. As the branch cannot bear fruit of itself, unless it abides in the vine, neither can you, unless you abide in Me. 5I am the vine, you are the branches. He who abides in Me, and I in him, bears much fruit; for without Me you can do nothing. 6If anyone does not abide in Me, he is cast out as a branch and is withered; and they gather them and throw them into the fire, and they are burned. 7If you abide in Me, and My words abide in you, you will ask what you desire, and it shall be done for you.

God doesn't want us just to visit but to occupy, to dwell and abide.

He wants to be a permanent resident of your life. And He wants you to be a permanent resident to all that He has prepared for you and me

2. A CHAIR - A THRONE for GOD. A **STOOL** represents a **THRONE**, a place of **AUTHORITY**.

Why is it so imperative that we learn to function by biblical authority? **A simple exercise will demonstrate our need.**

Take a blank sheet of paper and try to draw a straight line down the middle.

What will happen?

It will be crooked.

I don't care how steady your hand is, if you try to draw a straight line on your own there's going to be a curve in that line somewhere.

But now lay a ruler next to your line and draw another line with it.

The difference will be obvious.

You get the idea.

When you try to live life on your own, it's going to be crooked.

I don't care how much you try or how straight you are, your life is going to have bends in it because the best of us can't live a straight life on our own.

Yet, too many of us in the kingdom of God are trying to live life on our own, and we keep messing up.

But if we will let the Word of God be our ruler and draw our lives according to its standard, we'll straighten out the curves.

God's Word is the only authority that will enable us to draw a straight line in our personal life, in our family life, in the church, and in society.

How do you get God enthroned in your life?

Through praise...and worship.

We were created for praise.

Praise is our purpose.

We were raised to praise

He brought us from Death to life to worship

Let everything that has breath praise the Lord.

1 Peter 2:9...but you are a chosen generation.

A royal priesthood

A holy nation.

A peculiar people

That you should show forth the praises of Him that has called you out of darkness and into His marvelous light!

If you've got the life of God you ought to praise him.

You were:

Justified to glorify Him
Liberated to love Him
He took those sin shackles off your feet so you could dance!
Washed to worship Him
Redeemed to rejoice in Him
Delivered to dance
Set free to dance.
I am here today to throw a dance party for Jesus!

I am here today to defend old fashioned worship.

The Bible says if I don't praise him the rocks will cry out...
Ain't no rock gonna cry out in my place

Psalm 22:3 says, "God inhabits the praise of His people."

There is an ancient Japanese interpretation of this verse that says:

"Whenever people worship, God brings His big chair and sits down."

God gets comfortable when His people worship Him.

Don't you want God to get comfortable and bring His big chair where you
are?

Do you know how you get answers to prayer?

Do you know how to get God up in the middle of your life, circumstances
and situations.....you start worshipping Him, you create a seat, and He will
come down and sit in it."

Give God a seat in your house!
Give him a seat in your business!
Give him a seat in your car!
Give him a seat in your office!
The more you praise him the bigger that chair gets!

Dad's chair.

It is important for us to realize what supports us and who and what has authority in our life.

The Shunammite gave Elisha a chair – demonstrating her dependency was on God and she gave God her seat of authority.

What authority is sitting on your chair? Whoever or whatever controls your life – (drugs, alcohol, habits, sickness, disease, job, church, religion, satan, self, or God).

You might want to consider giving God a seat/throne in your life...because God's throne is:

God's throne is a place of power and authority. In 2 Chronicles 18:18, the prophet Micah relates his vision of God's throne room, in which spirit beings stand in attendance. Compare this to Job 1:6, where God demands answers from the angelic beings summoned there.

God's throne is a place of majesty and honor. The Bible says that, when Jesus ascended to heaven, He "sat down at the right hand of the throne of God" (Hebrews 12:2). There is no higher place than heaven. God is the King of heaven, and Jesus holds the place of honor at God's right hand.

God's throne is a place of perfect justice. "He has prepared His throne for judgment" (Psalm 9:7; cf. 89:14). The final judgment, described in Revelation 21, is held before "a great white throne" (verse 11).

God's throne is a place of sovereignty and holiness. "God reigns over the nations; God is seated on his holy throne" (Psalm 47:8; cf. 103:19). He does whatever He pleases, and all He does is good.

God's throne is a place of praise. John's vision of heaven includes a scene in which a "new song" is sung in praise to the One who occupies the throne (Revelation 14:3). Around the throne, the praise of God is surely "glorious" (Psalm 66:2).

God's throne is a place of purity. Only the redeemed, those who have been granted the

righteousness of Christ, will have the right to stand before His throne (Revelation 14:5).

God's throne is a place of eternal life. God is the Source of life. In heaven, John sees "the river of the water of life, as clear as crystal, flowing from the throne of God and of the Lamb" (Revelation 22:1).

God's throne is a place of grace. Not only does the throne of God represent judgment for the unbeliever, but it also represents mercy and grace for His children. "Let us then approach God's throne of grace with confidence, so that we may receive mercy and find grace to help us in our time of need" (Hebrews 4:16). Inside the Jewish temple was the Ark of the Covenant, which was a "copy of the true" (Hebrews 9:24), and it had a "mercy seat" where God's presence would appear (Leviticus 16:2, ESV).

3. A TABLE - FELLOWSHIP with GOD.....is your heart...the best way to get to know someone is over a meal sitting at a table...communion & fellowship.

A TABLE represents a place of FELLOWSHIP and COMMUNION.

Have you noticed that one of the best ways to get to know someone is over a meal? Somehow eating breaks down barriers and bonds are formed.

THE FIRST TABLE:

Do you realize that ...The First Mention of Table in the Bible is found in Exodus 25....

Do you realize that ---- God DESIGNED the first table! The KIND of TABLE that you are sitting at right now!

- **God told Moses to build a table for the Tabernacle.**
- **God is the architect/designer**
- **Dimensions**
- **Materials**
- **Accurate specifications.**
- **Moses was the general contractor**

God kept himself very separate from man He would appear in a burning bush, clap of thunder, but here He says....

I'm going to change my relationship w/you....I'm going to create a place where you can come to me. A plan to REDEEM man from his sin.

THE FIRST FURNITURE: ARK Of The Covenant

The first piece of furniture he told Moses to build was the Ark of the Covenant or we call it the Holy of Holies. None of these pieces of furniture ever existed before this. In this container my presence will dwell.

Only the priest could come in....separate me with a veil.

SECOND FURNITURE: A TABLE

The Second piece of furniture was a table....

Read....EXODUS 25:23-

The Table

23 "Make a table of acacia wood—two cubits long, a cubit wide and a cubit and a half high. **24** Overlay it with pure gold and make a gold molding around it. **25** Also make around it a rim a handbreadth wide and put a gold molding on the rim. **26** Make four gold rings for the table and fasten them to the four corners, where the four legs are. **27** The rings are to be close to the rim to hold the poles used in carrying the table. **28** Make the poles of acacia wood, overlay them with gold and carry the table with them. **29** And make its plates and dishes of pure gold, as well as its pitchers and bowls for the pouring out of offerings. **30** Put the bread of the Presence on this table to be before me at all times.

BREAD OF THE PRESENCE

THEN: set the Bread of the Presence....before me regularly....

The Table's PURPOSE was the "show the bread."

Shewbread: Means, "the bread of "face," b/c it was to lie continually before Jehovah as a meat offering of the 12 tribes.

It also means: "look at, meet with me."

Who is this? Who said I AM THE BREAD OF LIFE...

Just as the table always speaks of fellowship and communion, so the table of the shewbread points to Jesus who has made a covenant built on better promises and provided a blood covenant meal for us to partake that we might all be one in the Spirit.

John 6:35 And Jesus said to them, "I am the bread of life. He who comes to Me shall never hunger, and he who believes in Me shall never thirst."

Jn 6:51-58 "I am the living bread which came down from heaven. If anyone eats of this bread, he will live forever; and the bread that I shall give is My flesh, which I shall give for the life of the world. As the living Father sent Me, and I live because of the Father, so he who feeds on Me will live because of Me. This is the bread which came down from heaven-- not as your fathers ate the manna, and are dead. He who eats this bread will live forever."

The Table represents for us a way to HOST HIS PRESENCE every day!

It doesn't just have to be at church where you feel his presence.

You can take him home with you

To The grocery store.

To work...

David brought Ark of the Covenant to Mt.Zion and set it in the tabernacle.

David got the Ark of the Covenant and started bringing it back.

It was six miles from Obed-Edom, where the Ark of the Covenant was, to the tent of meeting David had setup.

A pace is two feet, two inches. Every six paces David would stop. So the journey went like this:

Step one . . . two . . . three . . . four . . . five . . . six.

"Hold it!" David would shout.

Everyone would stop.

David would build an altar.

Take an oxen.

Cut it, dress it, and lay it on the altar.

He would take a lamb, cut it, dress it, and lay it on the altar.

Then burn it up, worship God, and send up incense.

As soon as that was finished, he'd shout: "Pick it up! Move forward."

One . . . two . . . three . . . four . . . five . . . six steps.

"Hold it!" Build an altar. Kill another oxen.

Dress it. Lay it on the altar.

Take a lamb, etc. . . .

For six miles David did this. There were:

- 2,437 stops over six miles
- 406 stops per mile
- 2437 oxen slain

- 2437 calves slain
- If it took 30 minutes to prepare for the ritual sacrifice, that's 1,259 hours or 52 days to make a six mile journey.
- Add eight hours of sleep, and three hours to eat a day.
- That's 630 more hours.
- That's another 26 more days to cover six miles.
- **It took David 78 days just to move the ark a distance of six miles.**

David was king.

He had a lot of important things he needed to do.

There were lots of people he needed to meet with.

He was running a whole nation.

But he said, "There's nothing more important than entertaining the presence of God.

I must have his presence in my kingdom."

So he worshiped for 78 days.

It took him 2 months and 18 days to go SIX MILES!!!!!!

OMGoodness!!!!!!!!!!!!!!

1 Cor 6:19 your body is the temple of the Holy Spirit. He is in you...whom you have received of God.

David lived in an AWARENESS of GODS PRESENCE.

I tried something really neat the other day.

Set my timer for every 10 min

Stopped to worship

Hard to sin when your worshipping every 10 min.

David knew how to do this: After bringing the Ark of the Covenant back to Jerusalem...

David had 274 musicians surrounding the Ark of the Covenant.

In four different shifts,

twenty-four hours a day,

365 days a year,

for thirty-three years,
they played nonstop,
worshipping God.

1Chron 16:37...did not leave before the ark, but ministered continually...

Why do we need to continually praise God...

Here's why:

Revelation 12:10 says that Satan accuses us before God day and night. In the book of Job it says that Satan went in before God and accused Job.

Twenty-four hours a day there is a demon accusing you before the throne of God. The devil knows how to get into God's presence. **And if the devil is going to be there accusing, don't you want to be there praising—praising God that everything the devil is accusing you of is covered by the blood of Jesus?!**

If the devil is persistent enough to accuse day and night, **I'd hate to think the devil is willing to go through more to get into the presence to accuse us than we're willing to do to get into God's presence to praise.**

The devil doesn't let anything hinder him from getting into God's presence to accuse us. Don't let anything hinder you from getting into God's presence to worship!

nothing can separate me from God's Presence...

Nothing can separate us from the love of God...

Height/depth

no trial,
no X-ray,
no bill,
no cray cray kids,
no setback,
no financial crisis,
no burden,
if I can get worship I can get in God's presence.

4. A LAMP – The PRESENCE of GOD..How do you best experience His Presence?

LAMP

Do that assessment where it shows how you best experience his presence.

The lamp signifies the ILLUMINATION of God's REVELATION of HIMSELF to us.

How do I receive revelation?

Revelation receiver:

The trinity has been communicating together for an eternity and they decide to make us revelation receivers

GOD'S REVELATIONS ARE NEVER HAPPENSTANCE AND ARE ALWAYS GOOD

How God reveals Himself to you or what He reveals rarely happens the same way twice. But this much you can know for sure—God's revelations are never happenstance and are always for your good.

5. A COT – The MIRACLE of GOD....

She amended her whole house for the Man of God.

Are you AMENDING your life for someone else...

what areas am I willing to change to accommodate what God is doing?

Have you ever invited someone to stay at your house – you amend your life style to accommodate them – you don't run around your house in your underwear – because you have amended your life for someone else.

Have you been willing to change to accommodate what God is doing?

This Shunammite by making preparation for the man of God had actually prepared a room and furnished it for her own miracle!!!!

CHAIR:

2 Kings 4:9-10 (NKJV)

And she said to her husband, "Look now, I know that this *is* a holy man of God, who passes by us regularly. 10Please, let us make a small upper room on the wall; and let us put a bed for him there, and a table and a chair and a lampstand; so it will be, whenever he comes to us, he can turn in there."

The KJV says "let us set for him a stool"

kicce', or **kicceh**, kis-say'; from Hebrew 3680 (kacah); properly *covered*, i.e. a *throne* (as *canopied*) :- seat, stool, throne.

Webster defines: throne
the chair of state of a sovereign or high dignitary
(as a bishop)

the seat of a deity

royal power and dignity : **sovereignty**

an order of angels — see **celestial hierarchy**

What is a chair? - a device that **holds up** or **supports**.

It also can mean - an official seat or a seat of authority – an office or position of authority (a chair person).

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Dad's chair.

It is important for us to realize what supports us and who and what has authority in our life.

The Shunammite gave Elisha a chair – demonstrating her dependency was on God and she gave God her seat of authority.

What authority is sitting on your chair? Whoever or whatever controls your life – (drugs, alcohol, habits, sickness, disease, job, church, religion, satan, self, or God).

A **STOOL** represents a **THRONE**, a place of **AUTHORITY**.

Who is **SITTING** on your **THRONE**: is it **SELF**; is it **SIN**; or is it **CHRIST**

The **POWER** in your **LIFE** is **DEMONSTRATED** by who is **SITTING** on your **CHAIR**.

COT:

Have you ever noticed that when you go to sleep at night all the cares of this world vanish? It's because we are resting. The world still goes on, problems still exist, wars are still happening yet for that brief time of 6 to 8 hours we are in a state where our cares suddenly do not matter.

God wants us to enter into that state of "rest."

Jesus lived in that "rest."

Mark 4:37-38 (NKJV)

And a great windstorm arose, and the waves beat into the boat, so that it was already filling. 38But He was in the stern, asleep on a pillow. And they awoke Him and said to Him, "Teacher, do You not care that we are perishing?"

Have you ever invited someone to stay at your house – you amend your life style to accommodate them – you don't run around your house in your underwear – because you have amended your life for someone else.

Have you been willing to change to accommodate what God is doing?

TABLE:

Your TABLE is your HEART; does it GLORIFY GOD.

shulchan, shool-khawn'; from Hebrew 7971 (shalach); a table (as spread out); by implication a meal :- table.

Webster defines: table

3 a: a piece of furniture consisting of a smooth flat slab fixed on legs b (1): a supply or source of food (2): an act or instance of assembling to eat : meal <sit down to table> c (1): a group of people assembled at or as if at a table (2): a legislative or negotiating session <the bargaining table>

What is does the table represent? - It is a place of feeding, a place of fellowship, a place of communion.

How does your table look? Would you eat off of it?

Where is your table and how are you preparing it for the Lord?

Proverbs 3:1-6 (NKJV)

My son, do not forget my law, but let your heart keep my commands; 2for length of days and long life and peace they will add to you.

3Let not mercy and truth forsake you; bind them around your neck, write them on the tablet of your heart, 4and so find favor and high esteem in the sight of God and man.

5Trust in the Lord with all your heart, and lean not on your own understanding; 6in all your ways acknowledge Him, and He shall direct your paths.

A TABLE represents a place of FELLOWSHIP and COMMUNION.

Have you noticed that one of the best ways to get to know someone is over a meal? Somehow eating breaks down barriers and bonds are formed.

Is your table a shambles - would you let your boyfriend, girlfriend, your best friend, your mom or dad, husband, or wife, children eat off of it.

What about someone very important - Guess who's coming to dinner?

Jesus - yes the Master of the universe want to sit down at your table. Have you prepared it?

A TABLE represents a place of FELLOWSHIP and COMMUNION.

GOD has PREPARED for us a TABLE.

Your TABLE is your HEART; does it GLORIFY GOD.

ROOM

A lot of people ask Jesus to forgiveness of sins...but NEVER make Him LORD....

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Why is it so imperative that we learn to function by biblical authority? **A simple exercise will demonstrate our need.**

Take a blank sheet of paper and try to draw a straight line down the middle.

What will happen?

It will be crooked.

I don't care how steady your hand is, if you try to draw a straight line on your own there's going to be a curve in that line somewhere.

But now lay a ruler next to your line and draw another line with it.

The difference will be obvious.

You get the idea.

When you try to live life on your own, it's going to be crooked.

I don't care how much you try or how straight you are, your life is going to have bends in it because the best of us can't live a straight life on our own.

Yet, too many of us in the kingdom of God are trying to live life on our own, and we keep messing up.

But if we will let the Word of God be our ruler and draw our lives according to its standard, we'll straighten out the curves.

God's Word is the only authority that will enable us to draw a straight line in our personal life, in our family life, in the church, and in society.

Americans think that questioning or defying authority is our inalienable constitutional right. It carries down through our society, all the way to rebellion on the family level.

We resist the concept of authority.

We don't like submitting to anyone.

There are people that want a move of God but they want it their way. If we are to see God move then we must do it His way and come under His authority.

God's MOVE is UNDER His AUTHORITY.

First, do I have a settled commitment to submit to God's authority as revealed in His Word? Is Jesus truly my Lord? Selective obedience is really not obedience at all.

Second, am I under proper authority in the various God-ordained spheres? Do I submit to the government? What is my attitude in the church, at home, and at work? Am I only giving outward, grudging compliance, or am I obedient cheerfully from the heart?

Third, if I am in a position of authority, do I wrongly use it for selfish advantage or do I exercise it fearfully because of the responsibility before God?

Fourth, if I am in authority, do I lead with an air of superiority, or by humbly serving and blessing those I lead?

Fifth, if I am in authority, does my character elicit respect or does it undermine my leadership? Am I the first to obey the Word?

This Shunammite by making preparation for the man of God had actually prepared a room and furnished it for her own miracle!!!!

She thought she was going to just host the presence of God.

She thought she was just going to get in the Word and study a little bit....

She thought she was just going to start living Her life in a new direction...

BUTit all SET HER UP...for a MIRACLE...

The woman allowed the prophet to abide with her – the result God gave her a miracle.

God will TAKE whatever you GIVE for His USE and MULTIPLY it BACK to you AGAIN.

Have you prepared a room for Him?

`aliyah, something lofty, i.e. a stair-way; also a second-story room (or even one on the roof); figurative the sky :- ascent, (upper) chamber, going up, loft, parlour.

Webster defines: chamber

1: room; especially : bedroom

...a hall for the meetings of a deliberative, legislative, or judicial body b: a room where a judge transacts business —
....the reception room of a person of rank or authority.

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**Just as all authority is related to other authority, all rebellion is also interrelated.
It does not regard any class of authority.**

**Rebellion is “the unwillingness to be ruled by any source other than self.”
It is an indiscriminate contempt toward all authority.**

Our attitude toward Christ as our Lord, is directly associated with our attitude toward other authority.

Jesus Christ cannot be fully “Lord” over the person who harbors rebellion toward authority figures.

The Bible says, “Therefore whoever resists the authority resists the ordinance of God, and those who resist will bring judgment on themselves” (Rom. 13:2).

The prophet Samuel said, “...rebellion is as the sin of witchcraft, And stubbornness is as iniquity and idolatry” (1 Sam. 15:23).

The Apostle Peter said that those who are corrupt “despise authority” (2 Pet. 2:10), and the Proverbs say, “An evil man seeks only rebellion...” (Prov. 17:11).

Just as God is the source of all authority, Satan is author of all rebellion.

We may recall that the Devil (Lucifer), a former archangel, was originally cast out of Heaven because he led an insurrection against God (Isa. 14:12-15).

Rebellion is the very spirit of Satan's attitude (Eph. 2:2), and if we permit it to dominate us it will infect and taint our attitude toward all authority, including God and His Word.

You have the attitude of the devil if you are rebellious! Wow!

Considering how our attitude toward all authority relates to our submission to the "Lordship" of Christ, we should especially be sensitive to the authority of the Church and spiritual leaders, who have specifically been assigned as representatives of Christ. The Bible says, "Obey those who rule over you, and be submissive, for they watch out for your souls, as those who must give account. Let them do so with joy and not with grief, for that would be unprofitable for you" (Heb. 13:17).

Notice where she built the Chamber...

Put it upon the wall - this demonstrates the preeminence of God in

her life - not hidden away but in full view of all who may pass by.

Again there are people who want God to move in their life but they want it hidden from view.

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HAVE you PREPARED a ROOM for HIM?

((EXTRA NOTES About corrupt leaders:
cooperating with persons in leadership or authority. **Even if some in authority appear corrupt, or if we disagree with their politics or decisions, we should still demonstrate a similar cooperation and respect toward their authority... as long as their demands don't exceed the boundaries of God's laws.**

Fortunately in America, we have enjoyed a historic privilege of voting for our leaders, or voting them out if we see them become corrupt or incompetent. However, democracy hasn't always worked perfectly, especially as society has become more and more corrupt, and methods of manipulation such as the media have been used to manipulate popular opinion.

Despite these imperfections, citizens should always continue to exercise their right to vote, but Paul tells us that there is also another better way of dealing with those in authority when they become oppressive or ineffective... and that's by **praying for them. For those who don't understand the power of prayer, this only seems foolish or useless, but persons of faith understand that God can use prayers of faith to influence a leader in a variety of ways...** perhaps to change their heart, or to provide wisdom to make better decisions, or to orchestrate their removal from power entirely.

The Apostle Paul wrote, "I exhort first of all that supplications, prayers, intercessions, and giving of thanks be made for all men, for kings and all who are in authority, that we may lead a quiet and peaceable life in all godliness and reverence" (1 Tim. 2:1-2). This was an amazing admonition, considering that at the time, Paul was being held in a Roman dungeon by the wicked Emperor, Nero, who was notorious for his brutal and hideous persecution of Christians. The historian Tacitus wrote that Nero made the murder of Christians into a form of amusement or sport, who were "killed by dogs by having the hides of beasts attached to them, or they were nailed to crosses or set aflame, and, when the daylight passed away, they were used as nighttime lamps."¹

Paul realized that God is the ultimate authority in dealing with our issues with other authorities, since He views them as His servants, delegated to maintain law, order and to administer justice (Rom. 14:4, 1 Chron. 16:21-22). And although Nero was among history's most wicked rulers, who (after releasing Paul, jailed him again) ultimately ordered Paul's execution... God orchestrated the removal of Nero about a year later, by his own suicide in A.D. 68.)))))

LAMP

Do that assessment where it shows how you best experience his presence.

GOD'S REVELATIONS ARE NEVER HAPPENSTANCE AND ARE ALWAYS GOOD

How God reveals Himself to you or what He reveals rarely happens the same way twice. But this much you can know for sure—God's revelations are never happenstance and are always for your good.

The lamp signifies the ILLUMINATION of God's REVELATION of HIMSELF to us.

How do I receive revelation?

Many people ask me to pray for them to receive greater revelation from Scripture. While it's always an honor to bless someone with prayer, it is seldom understood how revelation comes, or to whom it comes. One of the greatest joys in life is hearing from God. There is no downside. But there is a cost that comes with the impartation.

The following is a list of practical suggestions for those wanting to grow in revelation from God.

1. Become childlike. Simplicity and humility of heart helps qualify a person to hear from God, while the desire to be profound is a wasted desire. What many discover after years of teaching is that the word that is simple is often the most profound. "At that time Jesus answered and said, "I thank You, Father, Lord of heaven and earth, that You have hidden these things from the wise and prudent and have revealed them to babes." (Matthew 11:25)
2. Obey what you know. Jesus taught His followers, "If anyone wills to do His will, he shall know concerning the doctrine, whether it is from God or whether I speak on My own authority." (John 7:17) "If anyone wills . . . he shall know" – Clarity comes to the one willing to do the will of God. The willingness to obey attracts revelation, because God is the ultimate steward, investing His treasures into fertile ground – the surrendered heart.
3. Learn the biblical art of 'meditation'. "I call to remembrance my song in the night; I will meditate within my heart, and my spirit makes diligent search." (Psalms 77:6) Biblical meditation is a diligent search. Whereas religious cults teach people to empty their minds as the means of meditation, the Bible teaches us to fill our minds with God's Word. Meditation has a quiet heart and a 'directed' mind. Mulling a word over in our heart, with a pursuit that springs from the inquisitive child's heart, is meditation.
4. Live in faith. Living by faith in my present assignment makes me ready for more. "Whose minds the god of this age has blinded, who do not believe, lest the light of the gospel of the glory of Christ, who is the image of God, should shine on them." (2 Corinthians 4:4) Notice that the light of the gospel comes to the person who believes. Revelation comes to the one expressing faith! Live with the understanding that God has already willed to give you His mysteries (Matthew 13:11), and ask accordingly. Then thank Him in advance.

5. Acquire an understanding heart. This sort of heart has the foundations in place for something to be constructed upon it. These are the basic concepts of the King and His kingdom. Proper foundations attract the builder (revelator) to come and add to those foundations. "But knowledge is easy to one who has understanding." (Proverbs 14:6) God wisely stewards fresh insight to those who have the basic principles in place. When fresh insights come, the understanding heart has a "slot to put it in". It is not lost as seed spilled on the ground.

6. Give God your nights. I try to end each day with my heart's affection stirred up and directed to the Holy Spirit. What an amazing way to go to sleep. The Song of Solomon reveals this poetically, "I sleep, but my heart is awake." (Song of Solomon 5:2) God loves to visit us in the night and give us instruction that we would have a hard time receiving during the day. (Job 33:15-16) The desire to give God our night season flows naturally from the child's heart that knows revelation cannot be earned. Ask Him specifically to minister to you in the night through visions and dreams. Once you have a dream or vision, write it out, and ask Him for understanding.

7. Give away what you have already received. Never underestimate what hungry people can "pull" from you while you minister the word. Being in a place of continual giving is a sure way of getting more. When we're in 'over our heads' in a ministry situation, we find out what God has been putting into us during the night. He draws out of the deep places in our hearts things that are not yet a part of our conscious thought processes. (Proverbs 20:5)

8. Become a friend of God. God shares His secrets with His friends. "No longer do I call you servants, for a servant does not know what his master is doing; but I have called you friends, for all things that I heard from My Father I have made known to you." (John 15:15) He makes all things known to His friends. Not only does He want to share all, He's invited us to ask anything of Him. But be accustomed to hearing more than you can share with others. Listen as He speaks, but speak only what He gives you freedom to speak about. Some things are revealed only because we're friends, and are not to be shared with others.

2 Kings 4:9-10 (NKJV)

And she said to her husband, "Look now, I know that this is a holy man of God, who passes by us regularly. 10Please, let us make a small upper room on the wall; and let us put a bed for him there, and a table and a chair and a lampstand; so it will be, whenever he comes to us, he can turn in there."

menowrah, men-o-raw'; or menorah, men-o-raw'; feminine of Hebrew 4500 (manowr) (in the original sense of Hebrew 5216 (niyr)); a chandelier :- candlestick.

Light is a result of revival or the presence of God and revival or the presence of God results in light.

What is the purpose of Light?

What does light do?

It removes or dispels darkness – the lamp – (Illustrate)

Webster defines: lamp – something that makes vision possible – (not just physical sight – the light of God gives people vision – “Where there is no vision the people perish.” – but you cannot have vision without light.

It brings illumination or revelation – greater truth, more liberty where the spirit of the Lord is – we simply “see” more – we see more of our darkness – we see more of God and as a moth is drawn to the light so we who hunger and thirst after righteousness are drawn to His flame!

Light DISPELS darkness; makes VISION possible; and brings REVELATION.

What is the significance of the lamp provided by the Shunammite woman?

She wants light!

RECAP:

at the various items represented in this biblical account.

The room – preeminence of God in your life,
the chair representing the throne of God in your life,
the table – a place of fellowship prepared for divine visitation,
and the lamp signifying the illumination of God’s revelation of Himself to us.

1. A ROOM - A PLACE for GOD.
2. A CHAIR - A THRONE for GOD.
3. A TABLE - FELLOWSHIP with GOD.
4. A LAMP - The PRESENCE of GOD.

Today the cot – or bed signifies a resting place.

5. The COT SIGNIFIES a PLACE of REST.

Now take your little piece of paper. Ask yourself

1. Have you made room for God? 2. Have you prepared a place for Him?
3. Does He sit on your throne? 4. Is your table clean? 5. Is your lamp lit?
6. Then what is it you would desire God to restore in your life?

Signed_____ Date_____

Expect a miracle if you have made room for God!!!!